



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

(d) Kinship and power.

(10 Marks)

Kinship is the web of social relations that arise either due to bloodline (consanguinal) or through marriage (affinal).

Kinship and power go hand-in-hand in many contemporary societies, however, in simple societies there is a low linkage between kinship and power. Eg. In !Kung bushmen, the leader of band is the one who is adept at hunting and it is not hereditary.

As there is evolution of societies from band to tribe to chiefdom, there is a clear centralization of power. With the rise in centralization, there is also a rise in nexus between kinship and power. As society evolves, the leadership



positions become hereditary thus causing kinship leading to power. Eg. The Vedic kings have become hereditary in later-Vedic period.

This led to rise in kingdoms, monarchies where the power passes from kin to next kin only. This led to monopolisation of political authority.

However, the evolution became paradoxical. With the rise of contemporary political institutions centred around democracy, the importance of kinship in power has decreased.

